SITE-SETUP SKILL

Your simple guide

Start any website project the right way, one small step at a time.

This guide is interactive. Click the stage buttons to jump around. Tick the boxes as you go (they work in most PDF viewers). Select the grey boxes to copy what to type.

What it is, in 30 seconds

1. It asks	2. It sets up	3. It hands you a prompt
Simple questions about your business, a few at a time.	Your project folder, safely, with your facts and your voice written down.	A ready-to-paste build prompt, made from your own answers.

NOTE It does **not** build the website itself, and it **never makes up facts** about your business. At every step it explains what it is doing and **waits for you to say "go"**.

The journey (click a stage)

0 Check	**1** Questions	**2** Files
3 Folders	**4** Safety check	**5** Your uploads
6 Upload check	**7** Design and plan	**8** Build prompt

Stages 0 to 6 set up and check your project. Stage 7 agrees the look and the plan. Stage 8 writes your build prompt.

Before you start

Tick each box when it is true for you. The grey ones are optional and can wait.

- [ ] **Node.js is installed** (version 20 or higher). To check, type `node -v` in a terminal.
- [ ] **A new, empty folder** for this project, with Claude Code opened inside it.
- [ ] **The skill is in that folder:** `.claude/skills/site-setup` (or in your personal skills folder).
- [ ] Optional: free **GitHub** and **Render** accounts. You can create them later.
- [ ] Optional: an **Unsplash Access Key**, only if you want free stock photos.
- [ ] Optional: **your own photos** (everyone in them agreed), your **logo**, a **keyword list**.

The minimum you must tell it

1. Business name
2. What you do, in one sentence
3. What you offer, or the pages you need
4. How people should contact you
5. The main goal of the site
6. The framework (or accept its recommendation)
7. How your writing should sound
8. A look you like (or pick one it suggests)

Everything else can be "I don't know". It leaves a note for later and moves on. Missing items become hidden sections or simple placeholders. It will not guess.

NEVER paste a key or password into the chat. **Type it into the `.env` file yourself.** If you ever paste one by mistake, create a new key and replace it.

The nine stages

Each row: what Claude does, what you do, and a box to tick. After most stages, **say "go"** to continue.

Tick	Stage	What Claude does	What you do
☐	**0 Check**	Looks at your computer and folder (Node, git, skills). If a project already exists, it only checks and changes nothing.	Read the short report. Fix anything it flags.
☐	**1 Questions**	Asks about your business, one small group at a time, and reads your answers back.	Answer in plain words. "I don't know" is fine.
☐	**2 Files**	Writes your project rulebook (`CLAUDE.md`) and your voice and facts files, only from your answers.	Read them. Correct anything wrong.
☐	**3 Folders**	Creates the folders, a safe `.gitignore` and an empty `.env`.	Nothing yet.
☐	**4 Safety check**	Runs a checking script and shows proof that private files cannot be uploaded by mistake.	Look for FAIL lines. Ask it to fix and re-run.
☐	**5 Your uploads**	**Stops** and gives you a checklist.	Add photos, logos and your keyword list. Type keys into `.env` yourself. Then say "go".
☐	**6 Upload check**	Lists your files and flags risky ones (receipts, IDs, screenshots). Changes nothing.	Remove anything flagged. Say "go".
☐	**7 Design and plan**	Suggests two or three simple looks if you have no reference, then a build plan.	Pick a look. Approve or change the plan.
☐	**8 Build prompt**	Writes `docs/BUILD-PROMPT.md` and shows it in the chat.	Copy it. Open a **new chat** in the same folder and paste it.

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What to type

Select a grey box to copy it. Type it in a **new chat** inside your project folder.

Starting

```
site-setup
```

Start a new project from scratch.

```
site-setup audit
```

Check an existing project. It changes nothing.

```
site-setup docs/my-build-spec.pdf
```

Start from your own build spec. Use your file's name.

```
site-setup build-prompt
```

Jump to the design and plan, then write the build prompt, on an existing project.

Moving on

```
go
```

Say this at each stop to continue. Read the report first.

After the build prompt

- [ ] Open a **new chat** in the same project folder.
- [ ] **Paste** the build prompt from `docs/BUILD-PROMPT.md` and answer its questions.
- [ ] **Approve the image map** before any photo is placed. Check every report before saying go.
- [ ] When the site is built and you are happy, you can add posts with the `blog` skill.

Choosing images each time you write a post:

`blog images=unsplash` free stock photos	**`blog images=local`** your own photos folder	**`blog images=mixed`** yours first, stock to fill gaps	**`blog images=none`** marked placeholders

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Get the best results

- [ ] **Give real facts, not guesses.** A blank is better than a wrong number.
- [ ] **Share a few things you have written** (emails, posts) so the writing sounds like you.
- [ ] **Bring a design reference** if you can: a screenshot or a link of a site whose look you like.
- [ ] **Use your own photos** for anything about your own work, people and results.
- [ ] **Read each report before you say go.** That is how mistakes get caught early.

If something looks wrong

It says Node is too old or missing	Install the current LTS version from nodejs.org, then start again.
The safety check shows FAIL	Read the line. It says what is wrong. Ask Claude to fix it and run the check again.
A file already exists	The skill never overwrites. It saves the new version next to it, ending in `.new`.
The skill does not appear	Check the file `.claude/skills/site-setup/SKILL.md` exists in your project, then start a **new chat**.
I pasted a key into the chat	Make a new key in that service and replace it in `.env`. Treat the old one as lost.

All done? Tick it off

- [ ] Project files created and read.
- [ ] Safety check passed with no FAIL lines.
- [ ] Uploads added and checked.
- [ ] Design and plan approved.
- [ ] Build prompt saved and pasted into a new chat.

My notes (click the box and type):

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